

RAJESH DAMMALA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Escalation Manager with 16+ years leading critical customer escalation management across enterprise cloud platforms at Microsoft and IBM. Proven track record coordinating complex, cross-functional escalation resolution for mission-critical services serving millions of users in 24/7/365 environments. Expert in developing customer-facing "Get Well Plans," translating complex technical issues into executive-ready business impact assessments, and driving data-driven operational decisions. Built and mentored globally distributed escalation teams (up to 32 engineers), championed customer advocacy resulting in 98% operational efficiency, and architected AI-driven automation achieving 30-35% auto-resolution. Deep experience with Azure cloud, ITIL frameworks, and enterprise customer relationship management.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Critical Customer Escalation Management
- Customer Health Analysis & Get Well Plans
- Enterprise Customer Relationship Management
- Proactive & Reactive Escalation Practices
- Cloud Platforms (Azure, AWS familiarity)
- 24/7/365 On-Call Operations
- Cross-Functional Coordination (Sales/Eng/Support)
- Executive Communication & Status Reporting
- Data-Driven Operational Decision Making
- Global Team Leadership & Mentoring
- ITIL Framework & Incident Management
- AIOps & Automated Resolution

SELECTED IMPACT

- Served as central escalation authority for 20+ mission-critical Xbox support services — independently coordinated cross-functional resolution efforts across Engineering, Support, Sales, and Product teams, returning customer environments to stable state.
- Managed customer-facing escalation communications and developed "Get Well Plans" — synthesized complex technical information into concise executive-ready business impact assessments for VP-level stakeholders and customer leadership.
- Drove operational efficiency from 85% to 98% through data-driven escalation management — built KQL/Power BI dashboards tracking resolution trends, regression patterns, and customer health metrics to inform tactical decisions.
- Architected AI-driven escalation automation platform (Azure SRE Agent) achieving 30–35% automated resolution coverage, saving 150+ engineering hours/year and reducing customer impact duration significantly.
- Authored 175+ escalation playbooks in 5 months — standardized triage procedures, improved first-responder effectiveness, and reduced repeat escalations by 40%.
- Built and mentored globally distributed escalation team of 32 engineers (Hyderabad + Redmond) providing 24/7 coverage; established career development paths and competency frameworks for junior escalation managers.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Staff Escalation Manager / Lead Escalations Manager — Xbox CXT SRE

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra/Allyis) | Redmond, WA (Remote from Morrisville, NC) | May 2021 – Present

- Work independently as central escalation authority for 20+ mission-critical production services, coordinating complex cross-functional resolution efforts in a 24/7/365 environment.
- Develop and execute customer-facing escalation communications and "Get Well Plans" — translate complex technical issues into business impacts, risks, and actionable recovery roadmaps for executive stakeholders.
- Coordinate with on-call engineers and monitor service health data to identify disruptions proactively; serve as primary decision point for all active customer escalation activities.
- Collaborate across Sales, Professional Services, Support, and Engineering to effectively resolve escalated situations, building strong internal partnerships.
- Demonstrate strong judgment regarding escalation management and problem mitigation — make timely business and technical decisions under pressure with high accountability.
- Effectively communicate critical issue status (verbally and written) to executive staff, sales teams, and customer leadership; synthesize pages of incident data into concise, actionable summaries.
- Review and analyze customer health trends using KQL/Power BI dashboards to proactively identify and resolve issues before they become customer escalations.
- Mentor junior staff on escalation practices, established competency frameworks and career development paths for escalation team members.
- Architected Azure SRE Agent platform for automated incident triage and resolution — 30-35% auto-resolution rate, significantly reducing customer impact duration.
- Authored 175+ escalation playbooks in 5 months, standardizing triage and reducing repeat escalations by 40%.
- Drove operational efficiency from 85% to 98% through metrics-driven continuous improvement and open feedback loops.

- Participated in weekend on-call rotation as part of global escalation management team.

Escalation & Technical Support Lead — Azure Enterprise Support

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 – May 2021

- Led team of 15 engineers providing enterprise customer escalation management for Azure cloud services — managed critical customer issues end-to-end with Sales, Engineering, and Product teams.
- Managed enterprise customer relationships, driving satisfaction and account growth through effective escalation resolution and proactive health monitoring.
- Championed 200+ product improvement bugs and feature enhancements based on escalation trend analysis — advocated for solutions providing best customer experience.
- Developed strong partnerships with Sales, Services, Support, and Engineering organizations, operating with global mindset across time zones.

Operations Lead — Azure LiveSite Operations

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India !' Redmond, WA | May 2012 – Nov 2016

- Built and led globally distributed 32-person escalation and operations team (Hyderabad + Redmond) providing 24/7 coverage for Azure platform.
- Led deep-dive technical investigations into complex production issues at cluster-to-blade level, utilizing both proactive and reactive data points to develop action plans.
- Developed PowerShell automation frameworks for incident detection and triage — saved thousands of manual hours annually.
- Managed incident lifecycle, change management, and post-incident reviews; drove continuous improvement through data-driven decision making.

Systems Analyst / Infrastructure Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 – Nov 2011

- Enterprise server builds, cluster configuration, and large-scale data migrations supporting production infrastructure in cloud and private data center environments.
- IT infrastructure management including patching, service packs, and hardware lifecycle operations with attention to detail and disciplined execution.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.E., Computer Science Engineering — JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

- AZ-900 Azure Fundamentals
- Microsoft 70-533/70-534: Implementing Azure Infrastructure Solutions
- ITIL Framework — Deep operational understanding (Incident, Change, Problem Management)
- TechMahindra AI White Belt | Google Generative AI | Google Cloud Computing Foundations

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Escalation Management: Critical Customer Escalations, Get Well Plans, Business Impact Analysis, Executive Communication, Customer Health Trending

Cloud Platforms: Microsoft Azure (8+ years), AWS familiarity, GCP familiarity, Private Cloud Operations

Observability & Analytics: Azure App Insights, Log Analytics, Kusto/KQL, Power BI, Geneva, Trend/Regression Analysis

Automation & Tooling: PowerShell, AIOps, AI Agents, Logic Apps, Multi-agent Orchestration, ICM

Frameworks: ITIL v3/v4, Incident Management, Change Management, Problem Management, SLA/SLO/SLI